

Operational Checklists for Direct Actions in the Classroom

Planning Checklist

Materials and Environment

- ☐ All required materials provided by school
- ☐ Visual supports prepared (diagrams, flowcharts, vocabulary cards)
- ☐ Multilingual keyword cards for technical terms
- ☐ Quiet workspace options available
- ☐ Sensory accommodation tools ready (headphones, fidgets)
- ☐ Adaptive technologies for physical needs
- ☐ Clear sight lines and accessible pathways

Content Preparation

- ☐ Culturally relevant examples and contexts identified
- ☐ Diverse role models selected and prepared
- ☐ Multiple demonstration methods planned
- ☐ Assessment alternatives ready
- ☐ Home language supports prepared
- ☐ Visual schedule and routine established

Differentiation Planning

- ☐ Individual accommodation plans reviewed
- ☐ Flexible grouping strategies decided
- ☐ Multiple engagement options prepared
- ☐ Various expression methods available
- ☐ Time accommodation plans ready

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Implementation Checklist

Universal Design for Learning

- ☐ Information presented in multiple formats (visual, auditory, kinesthetic)
- ☐ Student choice provided in topics or approaches
- ☐ Multiple ways to participate offered
- ☐ Cultural connections made explicit
- ☐ Collaborative opportunities structured

Engagement Monitoring

- ☐ All students actively participating in meaningful ways
- ☐ Gender-balanced speaking time and leadership
- ☐ Cultural backgrounds acknowledged and incorporated
- ☐ Individual needs being met through accommodations
- ☐ Social dynamics supporting inclusion

Language and Communication

- ☐ Simple, clear language used for instructions
- ☐ Visual demonstrations accompanying verbal explanations
- ☐ Peer translation and home language use encouraged
- ☐ Processing time allowed for language translation
- ☐ Multilingual supports utilized

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Socioeconomic Barriers Specific Checklist

Immediate Actions

- ☐ Provide all materials without requiring personal resources
- ☐ Create dignified device-sharing protocols
- ☐ Offer offline alternatives to online activities
- ☐ Avoid assumptions about home technology access
- ☐ Plan optional (not required) home extensions

Ongoing Support

- ☐ Use school equipment exclusively
- ☐ Provide printed resources for home reference
- ☐ Connect families with community resources appropriately
- ☐ Ensure group work doesn't require outside resources

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Cultural and Linguistic Barriers Specific Checklist

Preparation

- ☐ Prepare culturally relevant examples and contexts
- ☐ Connect with cultural liaisons or interpreters
- ☐ Plan for different communication and collaboration styles

Implementation

- ☐ Use visual demonstrations with verbal instructions
- ☐ Allow peer translation and home language discussion
- ☐ Value different problem-solving approaches
- ☐ Incorporate global innovations and diverse perspectives
- ☐ Respect varying learning style preferences

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Special Educational Needs Specific Checklist

Learning Disabilities

- ☐ Minimize text-heavy instructions
- ☐ Use color-coding and visual organizers consistently
- ☐ Break tasks into 5-10 minute segments
- ☐ Provide visual programming interfaces
- ☐ Offer multiple ways to demonstrate understanding

Autism Spectrum

- ☐ Follow predictable routines with visual schedules
- ☐ Define clear roles and specific expectations
- ☐ Provide sensory regulation options
- ☐ Use concrete, specific language
- ☐ Prepare for transitions with advance warnings

Physical/Sensory Impairments

- ☐ Ensure wheelchair accessible workspaces
- ☐ Provide alternative input methods for devices
- ☐ Use high contrast visuals and appropriate font sizes
- ☐ Offer tactile and audio alternatives
- ☐ Position students optimally for their needs

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Gender-Responsive Specific Checklist

Environment

- ☐ Use gender-neutral language and examples consistently
- ☐ Rotate leadership roles equitably
- ☐ Address interrupting and participation imbalances
- ☐ Display diverse STEM role models prominently
- ☐ Challenge stereotypes when they arise

Pedagogy

- ☐ Connect activities to social good and community impact
- ☐ Emphasize collaboration over competition
- ☐ Value process, creativity, and collaboration equally with technical skills
- ☐ Provide multiple pathways to success
- ☐ Use storytelling and narrative approaches

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Assessment and Feedback Checklist

Multiple Assessment Methods

- ☐ Verbal explanations and presentations
- ☐ Written reports and reflection sheets
- ☐ Physical demonstrations and builds
- ☐ Digital portfolios and video documentation
- ☐ Peer teaching and collaborative projects
- ☐ Self-assessment tools and rubrics

Inclusive Feedback Practices

- ☐ Focus on specific behaviors and growth
- ☐ Recognize different types of contributions
- ☐ Avoid gendered or culturally biased assumptions
- ☐ Provide feedback in multiple formats
- ☐ Include peer feedback structured for respect
- ☐ Document and celebrate all students' achievements

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Emergency Inclusion Protocol

When a student is struggling or becoming excluded:

Immediate Assessment (30 seconds)

- ☐ Identify barrier type: academic, social, physical, cultural, or linguistic

Rapid Intervention (1-2 minutes)

- ☐ Provide immediate accommodation or alternative approach
- ☐ Adjust grouping, role assignments, or activity complexity
- ☐ Offer additional support tools or resources

Monitoring (ongoing)

- ☐ Check in privately with the student
- ☐ Observe continued engagement and participation
- ☐ Modify activity further if necessary

Follow-up (after class)

- ☐ Debrief with student about what worked
- ☐ Plan adjustments for future lessons
- ☐ Communicate with support team if needed